

discover America. (Actually, America was already inhabited by a couple of million people who had "discovered" it centuries before. Columbus didn't discover America any more than Ed Koch discovered Manhattan. But who am I to argue with what I learned in the fifth grade?)

With \$743 a month you can't afford Paris, Vienna, or Geneva. But you can afford Madrid. And if you're willing to travel off-season and wait for special deals, you can arrange a low-cost trip from Madrid to the rest of Europe. When Vicki and I were in Spain in 1985, for example, we were offered round-trip airfare to London for \$50 each. For a few dollars more the tour people would throw in a hotel and breakfast for seven days. With deals like that, your biggest London expense is likely to be the jam you buy at Fortnum and Mason.

Spain is Velázquez and Goya, Cervantes and Hemingway, Franco and King Juan Carlos. Madrid is bullfights, music in the streets, doughnuts at 4:00 A.M., and open-air markets. Madrid is also seafood paella, fine red wine, and Fundador sherry brandy. Stockholm, Zurich, and Rome offer a great deal. But you could have so much fun in Madrid and the rest of Spain and Portugal that you'll forget about Europe's other great capitals.

Guadalajara, Rio de Janeiro, or Madrid. Bare-bones retirement is as easy as choosing among them. Before you take off, reread the rules in chapter 5 on how to move and the rules in chapter 8 on how to travel. After that, all you need is a spirit of adventure. In 1983 Peter A. Dickenson wrote a book called *Travel and Retirement Edens Abroad* (Dutton). He dedicates the book "to those who believe the social swim is fluid and that friendships are based on what a person *is*, not what he or she was . . . that everyone has a story to tell and you learn by listening." Bare-bones retirees are the kind of people Dickenson is talking about.